Ziv Cohen

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EDUCATION

University of Kansas — Lawrence, KS
B.S. Computer Science, *SELF Program, Honors* — Anticipated May 2028

Kanagawa University — Yokohama, Japan
Study Abroad — Summer 2025

EXPERIENCE

Aviation SWE Intern — *May 2026-August 2026*
Garmin — *Olathe, KS*
- Extended an existing **Python** document automation pipeline for the Aviation Common Library (ACL) to filter and generate compliance reports scoped exclusively to DO-178C supported components and features
- Overhauled the ACL audit sampling system to expand data coverage and accelerate generation, cutting Software Quality Assurance review time by **50%+**

Student Ambassador — *October 2024-Present*
University of Kansas — *Lawrence, KS*
- Representing the University of Kansas as a campus ambassador, delivering **70+** campus tours and engaging with prospective students to promote the university
- Gaining communication, management, and leadership skills through practical interaction

Catalyst Venture Fellow — *January 2025-May 2025*
KU Business School — *Lawrence, KS*
- Developing an immersive virtual reality game using **Unity** and **C++**, combining innovative gameplay design with interactive 3D environments
- Collaborating with the KU School of Business to scale the venture to be successful and profitable

PROJECTS

6-DOF Teleoperated Robotic Arm — *1st Place Award Winner on The Hive* — *June 2026-August 2026*
- Built a 6-DOF teleoperated robotic arm controlled via Meta Quest 3 VR, using **Unity (C#)** to stream real-time joystick data over UDP to a Raspberry Pi, which drives 6 servo motors through a PCA9685 driver board
- Implemented Unity's built in Inverse Kinematic (IK) solver for proper joint movement

Omnidirectional Rolling Bot (ORB) — *4th Place Award Winner on The Hive* — *August 2026*
- Built a Raspberry Pi Zero 2 W–powered spherical robot using three omni wheels, N20 motors, and custom Python kiwi-drive kinematics for multidirectional control.
- Integrated dual motor drivers, custom 12V-to-5V power distribution, and an onboard camera streaming 720p/30 FPS FPV video over Wi-Fi.

Get Big, Man — *Won HackKU "Best Beginner Project"* — *April 2025*
- Created a 2D roguelike game in **36** hours, starting with no experience in Unity or C++
- Designed all **original** music, pixel art, animations, and software entirely from scratch
- Developed gameplay mechanics and animations using **C++** scripts and **Unity** components

LEADERSHIP

Self Engineering Leadership Fellow (SELF Fellow) — *March 2025-Present*
- Selected as one of KU's Self Engineering Leadership Fellows, a highly selective **4-year** program recognizing top engineering students for leadership potential and academic achievement
- Gaining hands-on experience in leadership, business, and entrepreneurial skills through seminars, mentoring, and collaborative projects

University of Kansas Pickleball Team Vice President – *D1 Affiliated* — *August 2024-Present*
- Compete nationally against other universities in pickleball tournaments
- Over **15** hours of practice weekly, allowing me to reach a **4.2 DUPR** rating

Cube Satellite Software Developer (KUbeSat2) — *Team Member* — *September 2024-May 2025*
- Developing image analysis software in Python using OpenCV to assess vegetation health from satellite imagery by filtering and classifying color data